



World's fastest supercomputer

Frontier dethroned Japan's Fugaku as the world's fastest supercomputer.

<https://dgit.in/jun22-77>



Neanderthal art studio

Researchers discover a Spanish cave which was used as an art studio for over 50 years by the neanderthals. <https://dgit.in/jun22-78>

only reason Bitlocker uses hardware-based encryption is because that's available. However, it can choose to use the software-based method as well. Or, you can force it to always default to software-based encryption. This can be done via the Windows Group Policy editor. If you have Bitlocker available, then it's extremely likely that you will have access to Group Policy editor as well since both are clubbed with Windows 10 and 11. You can access it by typing 'gpedit.msc' in the Run prompt. Once you've got the Group Policy editor running, navigate to "Computer Configuration\Administrative Templates\Windows Components\BitLocker Drive Encryption\Operating System Drives" and double-click on the option called "Configure use of hardware-based encryption for operating system drives". Select "Disabled" and then apply the setting.

Please note that this setting applies to any device connected to your Operating System that has hardware-based encryption. So if you're using any USB stick or external storage device which has hardware-based encryption, they will all default to software-based encryption. Unless, of course, they've already been initialised to use hardware-based encryption in the first place. Or if you prefer software-based encryption on external devices then you will have to decrypt the hardware-based encryption completely first and then re-encrypt using software-based encryption. Popular tools such as VeraCrypt, AxCrypt and EncryptStick are great options to start out with. **[d]**

BUYING ADVICE

BUY A GRAPHICS CARD?

Q Hi Agent001!
My friends told me that graphics card prices have been falling and I personally checked it out as well and found it to be true. So I was wondering, should I get a new graphics card now or should I wait for a few months because I hear NVIDIA and AMD might be releasing their graphics cards very soon as well.

—Mahesh P

A Hey Mahesh,
Yes, graphics card prices have fallen significantly, although they've yet to normalise and hit pre-pandemic levels. However, that should happen very soon. As for your question about the new graphics cards launching. That's very much on the horizon. NVIDIA's RTX 4000 cards are expected to launch later this year in August-September and AMD's RDNA 3 cards should land a little later as well, as per their Q4 2021 earnings call. Both launches are still rumoured but it would appear NVIDIA is more or less going to launch their RTX 4000 cards within the expected time frame.

Then there's the upcoming recession fear as well as the global chip

shortage normalisation. The former might lead to some of the companies cutting back on their promises and the latter is more or less resolved for GPUs. Both, NVIDIA and AMD have been busy procuring additional sources for the materials required to manufacture their upcoming GPUs so that the shortage problems are alleviated.

We don't know what the performance will be on these cards and the safe bet is to go with a 5-10 per cent hike in pure performance. With that considered, it's wise to go for a graphics card now itself since the performance uplift isn't going to warrant a gen-on-gen upgrade anyway. You



AMD Radeon RX 6750 XT

can always opt to resell and upgrade to the new GPUs when they launch but that'll still end up costing you a little so it's best to buy right away if you have no discrete graphics card or if your GPU is 2-3 generations old. You haven't mentioned your budget so we can't give you a more pointed answer as to which GPU tier you should opt for. But the advice remains the same, more or less. **[d]**

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